

5 T'S THAT HELP YOU BURN FAT

Talking about losing weight; what comes to mind? Endless cardio and strict diets. Although it's a myth, people, especially women, still believe that if they want to lose weight, they shouldn't lift weights or do strength exercises. But that's not true. Strength training can help you burn fat, build lean muscle, and boost your metabolism without extreme diets or hours of cardio, according to certified fitness coach Hiba Farajallah. Through her experience with trainees, she identifies five key principles, the five T's, that can help anyone burn fat, build strength, and lead a healthier lifestyle.



1. I RAIN SMART

Don't rely on just one type of exercise. Combining both strength and cardio gives you faster, lasting results. Too much cardio can make you lose muscle, and only lifting can add muscle to the top of fat. The balance between both gives you tone, strength, and definition.

"Cardio burns calories temporarily, but strength training changes your body's metabolism for the long term", Coach Hiba said.

For example, one of her trainees named Rana used to spend all her gym time on the treadmill and saw little change. After adding strength sessions, she started feeling stronger and noticed visible definition within weeks.





2. I TAKE IT IN ORDER

Follow the formula: warm up, lift weights, finish with cardio. “This sequence protects your muscles, maximizes fat burns, and keeps workout effective”, said coach Hiba.

Warming up is like giving your body a friendly wake-up call, so it will prepare your muscles, joints, and heart for what's coming. “When you skip the warm-up, you risk injury and reduce performance,” Hiba explains.

Starting with cardio can drain your energy, while a proper warm-up keeps you efficient and strong.

Take Rayan, who used to start every session of sprinting. Once she switched to Hiba’s order, five minutes of dynamic warm-up, strength, then cardio; her energy levels lasted longer, and she no longer felt dizzy halfway through.

3. I REAT FOOD AS FUEL

Eat enough to recover, not restrict. Thus, you can apply a specific diet that suits your needs from like protein (from sources like fish, poultry, beans, and nuts), carbohydrates (especially whole grains, fruits, and vegetables), and fats (like those found in avocados, nuts, seeds, and olive oil).

The most important thing in applying a balanced diet is drinking enough water and staying hydrated.

One of her trainees, Lina, used to cut carbs completely, but she constantly felt tired and couldn’t finish her daily workouts. After adding balanced meals and post-workout snacks, her energy returned. “I stopped fearing food,” she said.

4. I RACK PROGRESS

It's obvious that scales say your advance, but it's not the only way. Taking your body measures every month can help you observe your real body changes. Observing your strength gain is another way, by easily lifting more weight or more repetitions. Also, losing weight can be observed by the difference in clothes where it may become more comfortable or less.

“Take a picture of your body on your first day and every month in the same lighting and pose so you can reveal changes numbers can't show”, coach Hiba noted.

For example, Nadine was disappointed when her weight barely changed after two months, but when she compared photos, she noticed toned arms and a defined waistline. “It was the best motivation to keep going,” she said.



5. I RUST THE PROCESS

Results take time, and consistency is the key. It's not a switch you can just flip. You need to give your body time, fat loss, and muscle gains don't happen overnight.

Focusing on your goals, following a healthy diet and lifestyle, and working out regularly matters. Stay patient and celebrate small victories. According to coach Hiba, “Progress is built day by day with patience, effort, and the belief that you can.”

Remember, discipline beats motivation.

One of her long term clients, Maya, didn't see progress for the first six weeks and almost gave up. By the third month, her energy, sleep, and mood had transformed even before the physical changes appeared.

Coach Hiba remind us, “**Fitness isn't about doing more, it's about doing right.**” Combine strength, cardio, and consistency, and you'll start to see results in your energy, confidence, and everyday life.